One of the worst things you can do is give someone a dashboard where the data they need isn't right where they expect it to be. When this happens, people will be less likely to look at it.

Ensure people know that data is there as a tool, not a weapon

The biggest fear people have around metrics is that someone will use them to prove they're not good or not good enough. Never use metrics as a weapon. Always communicate that the data is there to help everyone understand how the team is working and to help track improvements to their process.

Look for opportunities inside your environment to evangelize these techniques in a positive way. I've found that starting off retrospectives with data ends up leading to honest and open conversations that help everyone understand how their work affects metrics and why they're important to track.

Ensure that the people generating the data have a say in which metrics they think are most important. For example, if you think you should be measuring CLOC, ask your development team what they think of the idea. If they don't like that metric, ask why; this will usually lead to them helping you determine which metrics they actually care about. Inclusion in the conversation and collaboration from the team will lead to better success and broader buy-in.

Use page tracking to understand how your dashboards are used

Your dashboard is a product for a consumer, so treat it that way. I've found that often internal tools aren't tracked the same way consumer-facing tools are, which ends up leading to things people don't use or aren't happy with. By using page tracking on your dashboards, you'll see what people click on the most, what they're drilling in on, and how frequently they use them. You can then use this information to continue to hone which metrics mean the most to your team and your company. Go back to chapter 6 and apply the same techniques you would to track success on your metrics dashboards. Some metrics that I've found useful in this context are page hits and metric clicks: